FRANCESCO ABER

ART DIRECTOR

ANIMATION FILMMAKER · EDUCATOR



Am.Bush · ambush.info

CONTACT

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PROFILE

Art director and animation filmmaker (Centro Sperimentale di Cinematografia) with over ten years of creative direction for advertising, film and new media, based in Barcelona and working with clients in Spain, Italy and the US.

I design and lead animation programmes in schools: each project reaches around 500 students, is fully funded by the Italian Ministry of Culture, and ends in a short film screened in cinemas, including at the 80th Venice International Film Festival.

My graduation short *The Age of Rust* was selected at Annecy and shortlisted for the Nastri d'Argento. Today I bring generative AI and augmented reality into both my production and teaching work.

SKILLS

Art direction · VFX supervision · 2D/3D animation · motion graphics · character design · augmented reality

SOFTWARE & TOOLS

Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects, Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve, Maya, Blender, Figma, ARKit; all major AI image and video generators.

EXPERIENCE

AR Content, Animation & Character Design — "ARtales"

2026 — present

"Riscoprire i Sentieri delle Donne Carbonaie" · Limbo and BluMagma, with the Municipality of Isola del Gran Sasso and Museo Centro per le Acque

Augmented reality experience along the Charcoal Burners' Trail (Sentiero dei Carbonai), inspired by the work of Lucia Marcone.

Teacher & Art Director — "Cinema e Immagini per la Scuola" programme

2022 — 2026

Liceo Artistico Musicale Coreutico "Misticoni Bellisario", Pescara · Italian Ministry of Culture (MiC) call, fully funded

- **Scale:** around 500 students per project; 100 hours of in-class teaching per year plus hands-on workshops.
- **Output:** at least one animated or mixed-media short film produced every year.
- **Screenings:** a minimum of two public screenings per project at Sala Sant'Andrea and Cinema Massimo, Pescara.
- **Editions:** 2025/26 "Cine-Convergenze" · 2024/25 "Nuvole Animate" (animation, comics, film criticism and IT) · 2022/23 "AnimArte".
- **Highlight:** the short film "Animarte", made by BluMagma with the students, was screened at the 80th Venice International Film Festival in "Ad Occhi Aperti, episode 3", promoted by ANAC.

Founder & Art Director — Am.Bush Studio

2016 — present

Barcelona · communication studio for advertising and new media

Branding, film and social media content. Clients include Grateful Seeds, Sala Apolo, The Crib Concierge, Cali-Kosher (USA) and Venero Skateshop.

Founder, Art Director & VFX Supervisor — BluMagma

2015 — present

Association of filmmakers

Multimedia workshops, film festivals and projects promoting audiovisual culture across Italy. Art direction and VFX supervision on short films (2015–2018).

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TEACHING

Programme direction, classroom and workshop teaching, public speaking; Google Classroom, Google NotebookLM; generative AI for creatives. Team leadership and project management of publicly funded projects.

LANGUAGES

Italian — native

Spanish — B2

English — B2

Catalan — A1/A2

EDUCATION

Master in Artificial Intelligence for Creatives
Founderz Business School (online) · 2026

Diploma in Animation Cinema
Centro Sperimentale di Cinematografia, Piedmont branch (Turin) · 2014

First-cycle degree in Performing Arts and Sciences
Sapienza University of Rome · 2009

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Motion Graphics & Animation
2021/22
Titbit.tv

Art Direction & Web Design
2019/22
freeweedmentality.com (e-commerce)

Artistic & Technical Director and Teacher — "Leo City"
2018
BluMagma · Italian Ministry of Culture call "Cultura Futuro Urbano — Scuola Attiva la Cultura", with the Municipality of Pescara and CNA Abruzzo

Junior Layout Artist — CGI series "Footrue"
2014/15
Maga Animation

Director & Animator — short film "The Age of Rust"
2014
Graduation film, Centro Sperimentale di Cinematografia

SELECTED WORK

- **Music videos:** animation, keying and motion graphics for Morelove Prod. (Fido Guido, Don Rico), 2021–22.
- **"Laika Stardust":** short film for Limbo Produzioni — VFX, animation, puppet animation, compositing and character design.
- **"Non fare il mostro":** Boing TV × CSC partnership — direction, animation and character design.
- **Branding & illustration:** brand identity and social media (The Crib for Kicks), the #playasyouare Pride campaign, logo design and event posters.

Studio work on Instagram: Am.Bush Studio @am.bush

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

For the short film "The Age of Rust"

- **Finalist:** final five, Best Animated Short Film — Nastri d'Argento 2015
- **Winner:** Best Animation, Best Story, Best Graduation Film — Corto Lovere 2014
- **Winner:** Best Environmental Student Film — AnimArte Festival 2014
- **Winner:** Audience Award for Best Animation — Purbeck Film Festival 2014
- **Winner:** Best Student Work — Libelula Animation Fest 2014

Official selection at 20+ international festivals, including Annecy International Animation Festival (2014), Sitges, Milano Film Festival, ITFS Stuttgart, Anima Brussels, Trieste Science+Fiction, VGIK Moscow, SESIF Seoul, Shorts Shorts Film Festival Asia, Cartoons on the Bay, Rome Independent Film Festival and Animex.

Jury member — EKOFILM 2015, Environmental Films category.